

WORKSHEET: Compound & Complex Sentences

Name: _____ Date: _____

Part A: Identify the Sentence Type

Instructions: For each sentence, circle the correct sentence type and underline the conjunction(s). Some sentences contain a dependent clause at the **beginning**; others contain it at the **end**. Read carefully before you decide.

Sentence types: S = Simple · CD = Compound · CX = Complex

1. The concert was cancelled, and the audience left disappointed. (S / CD / CX)
2. Because the road was blocked, we took a longer route. (S / CD / CX)
3. She studied for hours but still felt unprepared. (S / CD / CX)
4. I will call you when the meeting ends. (S / CD / CX)
5. The power failed during the storm, so we lit candles. (S / CD / CX)
6. Whenever he tells that story, everyone laughs. (S / CD / CX)
7. My brother packed his bags and boarded the early train. (S / CD / CX)
8. Although the exam was difficult, most students finished on time. (S / CD / CX)
9. The café serves breakfast until eleven, but the queue starts at seven. (S / CD / CX)
10. I will not agree to the plan unless you explain it properly. (S / CD / CX)

Part B: Add Commas Where Necessary

Instructions: Rewrite each sentence with correct commas. **Some sentences need no commas at all.** Think carefully: is there an introductory dependent clause? Are two **independent** clauses being joined by FANBOYS? Is the subject shared between the two halves?

11. Before the lecture began the professor handed out the revision notes.
12. I packed my own lunch but forgot to bring it to school.
13. The library closes at nine so we had to leave earlier than planned.
14. She speaks three languages fluently although she has never travelled abroad.
15. While the guests were arriving the host realised that the food was still in the oven.
16. The film was long and the ending was predictable.
17. He apologised sincerely because he knew he had been wrong.
18. I finished the report and emailed it to my manager.

Part C: Create & Rewrite

Instructions: This exercise tests whether you can **produce** the three sentence structures with correct punctuation. Write clearly and use commas where they are required. For Questions 22–24, make sure

your complex sentences cover **both** cases: one with the dependent clause at the beginning, and one with the dependent clause at the end.

19. Write a **simple sentence** of at least ten words.

20. Write a **compound sentence** using the FANBOYS conjunction **yet**. Punctuate correctly.

21. Write a **compound sentence** using the FANBOYS conjunction **so**. Punctuate correctly.

22. Write a **complex sentence** with the dependent clause at the **beginning**. Use the subordinator **Although**.

23. Write a **complex sentence** with the dependent clause at the **end**. Use the subordinator **because**. (Warning: this one does not need a comma.)

24. Rewrite your sentence from Q22 so the dependent clause is now at the **end**. Change punctuation as required.

25. Rewrite the following simple sentences as **one compound sentence**, correctly punctuated:
The rain had stopped. The children rushed outside.

26. Rewrite the following simple sentences as **one complex sentence**, correctly punctuated. Place the dependent clause at the **beginning**:
The bell had rung. The students remained in their seats.

Quick reminders:

- Comma **after** an introductory dependent clause (*Although it was late, I* *Because it rained,*)
- Comma **before** FANBOYS when joining two **independent** clauses
- **No comma** when the dependent clause comes at the end (*... because I was tired.*)
- **No comma** when FANBOYS joins a verb to a **shared subject** (*She packed her bag and left.*)